

HL

RESPONSIBLE-AI ADOPTION PILOT

Cultivating the future of legal practice in Chicago

Willkie Farr & Gallagher · Chicago Office · A bounded 90-day training & adoption pilot

Prepared by Alex Donnelly — Legal Tech & AI Training

Why now

AI is already in the building. The question is whether people use it well — and safely.

The tools are here

Attorneys and staff are experimenting with GenAI already. A pilot turns scattered use into safe, supported practice.

Adoption is a people problem

New tools don't change habits on their own. Training, coaching, and trust are what make them stick.

Clients are asking

Firms are being asked what their AI posture is. Doing this deliberately is now a competitive necessity.

Start small, prove it

One group, one set of workflows, guardrails first — then expand on evidence, not hype.

The goal

Help one Chicago practice group use approved AI tools confidently and safely — reducing friction and improving quality, without ever compromising confidentiality, accuracy, or professional judgment.

Not a firmwide rollout. Not a tool demo. A bounded, measured pilot that builds a repeatable playbook for the rest of the firm.

Five non-negotiable principles

Every decision in the pilot is measured against these — and the last one is absolute in a law firm.

1

Low-risk first

Start with workflows where a mistake is caught early and easily, never client-facing filings unreviewed.

2

Human-reviewed

An attorney owns every output. AI assists; it never decides. Verify against source, always.

3

Measurable

Baseline before, measure after. If we can't show the change, we don't claim it.

4

Iterative

Small cycles, real feedback, adjust. Scale only what demonstrably works.

5

Secure & confidential

Approved tools only. No client or privileged data into anything unapproved. Data classification up front.

Scope — what's in, what's out

A tight boundary is what makes the pilot safe, measurable, and fair to evaluate.

IN SCOPE

- One Chicago practice group + one champion
- Document summarization & first-pass review
- Research & drafting assistance (reviewed)
- Microsoft 365 Copilot for everyday work
- Role-based training, onboarding & coaching
- Adoption, time, quality & confidence metrics

OUT OF SCOPE (for now)

- Unreviewed client-facing filings
- Any client or privileged data in unapproved tools
- Firmwide rollout before evidence
- Autonomous / agentic actions without a human
- New matter intake or billing systems
- Tools outside the approved stack

The approved tech stack

A small, governed set of tools — each with a clear job and clear guardrails.

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Everyday drafting, summarizing, and search inside the tools people already use — Word, Outlook, Teams.

Firm tenant · data stays in-boundary

Filevine Lois

Matter-aware assistance on documents and records within the case-management system.

Reviewed output · matter-scoped

Claude (approved workspace)

Higher-order drafting, analysis, and reasoning for non-privileged work, with human review.

No client/privileged data · verified

Training built for each role

A firm is not one audience. Adoption fails on one broad session — so training is role-specific and hands-on.

Partners

Strategic value, risk, and client implications — short, high-level, decision-focused.

Associates

Stronger research, drafting, and analysis — with verification habits built in from day one.

Paralegals & case managers

The volume work: summarizing, organizing, first-pass review — practical, repeatable workflows.

Administrative staff

How new workflows change day-to-day tasks — clear, confidence-building onboarding.

A phased 90 days

Guardrails first, then hands-on enablement, then supported practice, then an evidence-based decision.



How we measure value

Baseline before, measure after — across adoption, value, quality, and risk. Illustrative targets.

→ **90%**

Weekly active users in the cohort

3–5 hrs

Time returned per person / week

100%

Outputs verified against source

↑

Self-reported confidence with the tools

Watched throughout: misuse, hallucination, and confidentiality signals — logged and routed to the right people early, not after the fact.

The ask

- 1 Name the group**

One willing Chicago practice group and one champion to pilot with.
- 2 Confirm the stack**

Sign-off on approved tools and the data-handling guardrails.
- 3 Give us 90 days**

A bounded window to train, support, measure — and report back with evidence.
- 4 Then decide**

Expand, adjust, or stop — based on what the data actually shows.